

Shanaya Vanhooren

Institut national de la recherche scientifique
Urbanisation Culture Société
Montreal, Québec, Canada

Email: shanaya.vanhooren@inrs.ca
Website: www.shanayavanhooren.com

Academic Appointments

Institut national de la recherche scientifique (INRS)

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Canadian Municipal Barometer Partnership

Sept. 2025 – Present

Education

The University of Western Ontario

Ph.D. Political Science

2025

Fields: Canadian Politics and Urban and Local Politics

Dissertation Title: Programmatic Polarization and Party Position Change
in Canadian Provincial Party Systems, 1945-2020

Dissertation Committee: Dr. Zack Taylor (Supervisor),
Dr. Laura Stephenson, Dr. David A. Armstrong II

University of Waterloo

M.A. Political Science, Thesis-Based

2018

Wilfrid Laurier University

B.A. Honours History and Political Science with Research Specialization (Double Major)

2017

Research and Teaching Interests

Research: Canadian provincial party systems; local politics; public policy; representation

Teaching: Canadian politics; Public policy; Quantitative text analysis; Introduction to quantitative research methods

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

6. **Vanhooren, Shanaya**, Jack Lucas, and Sandra Breux. Forthcoming 2026. "Municipal Issue Publics." *Urban Affairs Review*. Accepted: July 10, 2026.
5. Lucas, Jack, Martin Horak, **Shanaya Vanhooren**, and David A. Armstrong II. 2026. "Geographic Proximity Dampens Ideological Policy Disagreement in Urban Politics." *Nature Cities* 3: 514-522.
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s44284-026-00450-y>
4. Horak, Martin and **Shanaya Vanhooren**. 2024. "Somebody to Lean On: Community Ties, Social Exchange, and Practical Help During the COVID-19 Pandemic." *City & Community* 23(1): 3-25.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/15356841231159370>

3. Taylor, Zack and **Shanaya Vanhooren**. 2021. "Local Election Campaign Finance Regimes in Canada: Toward a Research Agenda." *Canadian Public Administration* 64(1): 99-121. <https://doi.org/10.1111/capa.12400>
2. Alcantara, Christopher, Sheri Longboat, and **Shanaya Vanhooren**. 2020. "Improving First Nations Water Security Through Governance" *Canadian Public Administration* 63(1): 155-176. <https://doi.org/10.1111/capa.12363>
*Among top 10 most downloaded Canadian Public Administration articles 2019–2020.
1. Henstra, Daniel, Jason Thistlethwaite, and **Shanaya Vanhooren**. 2020. "The Governance of Climate Change Adaptation: Stormwater Management Policy and Practice." *Journal of Environmental Planning and Management* 63(6): 1077-1096. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09640568.2019.1634015>

Policy Reports and Non-Referred Contributions

3. **Vanhooren, Shanaya**. Forthcoming Oct 2026. "Disagreements in Municipal Politics: How location shapes the ways residents think about policy." *Municipal World*. Accepted: July 13, 2026.
2. **Vanhooren, Shanaya**. June 2026. "Close to Home: How the location of policies shapes how people think about them." Canadian Municipal Barometer Substack.
1. **Vanhooren, Shanaya**. 2019. "Beyond the Big City, Appendix A: Jurisdictional Scan." *Pathways to Prosperity Partnership*. Report for Immigration, Refugees, and Citizenship Canada and the Government of Ontario. 47 pages. https://ppforum.ca/wp-content/uploads/2019/07/BeyondTheBigCity_AppendixA-JurisdictionalScan-PPF-July2019-1.pdf

Current Research

Manuscripts Under Review

Vanhooren, Shanaya. "Issue Salience in Party Platforms: Introducing the Canadian Archive of Provincial Party Manifestos 1945-2025." Under review at *Canadian Journal of Political Science*.

Working Papers

Vanhooren, Shanaya. "Programmatic Polarization in Provincial Elections 1945-2020."

Vanhooren, Shanaya. "Timing and Magnitude of Position Change Among Canadian Provincial Parties."

Vanhooren, Shanaya, Zachary Spicer, and Gabriel Eidelman. "Centralizing Authority in Local Government: The Introduction of Strong Mayor Powers in Ontario, Canada."

Breux, Sandra, and Shanaya Vanhooren. "Informality and Accountability: Conversations Between Municipal Elected Officials and Citizens."

Research Experience

Co-Principal Investigator 2025-
Canadian Agendas Project

Research Assistant 2024-
Dr. Zack Taylor (The University of Western Ontario) et al.
SSHRC Insight Development Grant.
Money and Local Democracy Project

<i>Lead Research Assistant - Public Policy Pillar</i> Dr. Martin Horak (The University of Western Ontario) Canadian Municipal Barometer Partnership	2024-2025
<i>Research Assistant</i> Dr. Martin Horak (The University of Western Ontario) Network for Economic and Social Trends (NEST) Community Ties and Mutual Aid During the COVID-19 Crisis	2021
<i>Research Assistant</i> Dr. Jack Lucas (University of Calgary) et al. SSHRC Insight Development Grant Cities in Canadian Political Development	2020-2021
<i>Research Assistant</i> Dr. Victoria Esses (The University of Western Ontario) Pathways to Prosperity Partnership	2019
<i>Research Assistant</i> Dr. Daniel Henstra (University of Waterloo), SSHRC Insight Development Grant Multilevel Governance and Climate Change Adaptation Policy in Canada	2016-2018

Awards, Grants & Scholarships

External

<i>Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (SSHRC)</i> Insight Development Grant. "Who Parties Speak For: Group and Policy Appeals by Canadian Political Parties" (\$42,468 CAD)	2026
<i>Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (SSHRC)</i> Joseph-Armand Bombardier CGS Doctoral Scholarship (\$105,000 CAD)	2020-2024
<i>Canadian Political Science Association</i> Congress Graduate Merit Award (\$500 CAD)	2024
<i>Ontario Provincial Government</i> Ontario Graduate Scholarship (\$15,000 CAD) *Declined to accept SSHRC CGS-D	2020-2021
<i>Ontario Provincial Government</i> Ontario Graduate Scholarship (\$15,000 CAD)	2019-2020

Internal

<i>The University of Western Ontario</i> Western Postdoctoral Fellowship (\$70,000 CAD) *Declined to accept INRS Postdoctoral Fellowship	2025-2027
<i>The University of Western Ontario</i> Dr. Harold D. Clarke Graduate Quantitative Research Methodology Fellowship (\$5,000 CAD)	2024
<i>The University of Western Ontario</i> Research, Training and Development Fund (\$450 CAD)	2018, 2021

University of Waterloo 2017
Arts Graduate Senate Scholarship (\$1,500 CAD)

University of Waterloo 2017
Teaching Assistant Excellence Award (\$1,000 CAD)

Presentations

Conference & Workshop Presentations

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) Annual Conference (Ottawa, Ontario) 2026
“Informality and Accountability: Conversations Between Municipal Elected Officials and Citizens.” (with Dr. Sandra Breux)

Atlantic Provinces Political Studies Association Annual Conference (Fredericton, New Brunswick) 2025
“Timing and Magnitude of Programmatic Change Among Canadian Provincial Parties”

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) Annual Conference (Toronto, Ontario) 2025
“Programmatic Polarization in Canada’s Provinces.”

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) Annual Conference (Montréal, Québec) 2024
“Stable or Volatile? Provincial Party Positions in Canada, 1945-2020.”

Canadian Municipal Barometer Speaker Series (Virtual) 2025
“Municipal Issue Publics.” (with Drs. Jack Lucas & Sandra Breux)

MapleMeth Regional Methodology Conference (London, Ontario) 2023
“The Canadian Provincial Parties Manifestos Dataset: Leveraging RoBERTa for Classification.”

Western University Graduate Association of Political Science, Workshop Series 2023
“Introduction to Regular Expression in R.”

Western University Graduate Association of Political Science, Workshop Series 2022
“Introduction to R Workshop: Objects and Operations.”

American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Conference (Montréal, Québec) 2022
“Canadian Provincial Party Systems 1945-2020: Evidence from Party Platforms.”

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) Annual Conference (Virtual) 2021
“Canadian Political Science as a Living Tree: Text Analysis of the *CJPS* 1968-2014.”

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA) Annual Conference (Virtual) 2021
“Somebody to Lean On: Community Ties and Practical Help During COVID-19.” (with Dr. Martin Horak)

NEST COVID-19 Recovery and Resilience Workshop (The University of Western Ontario, Virtual) 2021
“Somebody to Lean On: Community Ties and Practical Help During COVID-19.” (with Dr. Martin Horak)

Invited Speaker

Elections & Voting (third year undergraduate course) 2026
University of Western Ontario, London, Ontario
“Canadian Political Parties’ Policy Positions Through the Lens of Party Competition”

Career Night for Laurier Arts Scholars: Discussions with Alumni 2021
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, Ontario

Research Methods in Political Science (third year undergraduate course) 2021
King's University College, London, Ontario
“Qualitative and Quantitative Text Analysis: Practical Uses in Political Science Research”

The Institute of Public Administration of Canada (IPAC) 2020
“Improving Water Quality in Indigenous Communities”

Advanced Methods Training

Quantitative Research Methods

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research
Data Science & Text Analysis; Maximum Likelihood Estimation II 2020

Department of Political Science, The University of Western Ontario
Quantitative Methods; Machine Learning 2020

Department of Knowledge Integration, University of Waterloo
Fundamentals of Automated Text Analysis for Social Scientists 2018

Qualitative Research Methods

Faculty of Social Science, The University of Western Ontario
Using NVivo 12 for Qualitative & Mixed Methods Research 2019

Teaching

Instructor of Record

Data Science for Politics Winter 2025
University of Western Ontario, 3rd Year Undergraduate
(Enrollment: 69)

Introduction to Public Policy Winter 2022, Winter 2024
University of Waterloo, 3rd Year Undergraduate
(Enrollment in 2022, 2024: 24, 23)

Teaching Assistant

Public Administration and Policy 2018-19, 2019-20
The University of Western Ontario, 3rd Year Undergraduate

Pedagogical Training

Decolonizing The Academy: Finding Your Role 2022
The University of Western Ontario, Centre for Teaching and Learning, Future Prof Workshop Series

13th Annual Teaching and Learning Conference

2022

University of Waterloo, Centre for Teaching and Learning

Workshops attended:

Fostering Student-Faculty-Staff Partnerships through Open Pedagogy

Partners in Failure, Partners in Learning: Modeling Failure Intervention Pedagogy in the Classroom

Support and Equity: Using Socially Shared Learning Regulation to Create Responsive and Accommodating Learning Cultures

Undergraduate Student Perspectives of Failure: How Can Instructors Foster Resilience and Encourage Help-Seeking?

Media

The Hamilton Spectator

August 6, 2026

“Where are the candidates? No competition in half of Norfolk County’s municipal wards.” Provided expert commentary on the upcoming Ontario municipal election.

The Hamilton Spectator

June 1, 2026

“‘Publicity stunts’ or power grab? Here’s how strong-mayor powers are wielded in Haldimand-Norfolk.” Provided expert commentary on how the new ‘strong mayor powers’ are being used in Ontario.

The Hamilton Spectator

March 5, 2025

“Independent’s day in Haldimand-Norfolk.” Provided expert commentary on the 2025 Ontario election.

Field Experience

Halifax, Nova Scotia

October 2024

Municipal Election Candidate Interviews & Campaign Observation

Service

The University of Western Ontario, Department of Political Science

Executive, Graduate Association for Political Science

2020–2022

The Discipline

Co-Section Head, Local and Urban Politics

2026

Canadian Political Science Association Annual Conference Programme Committee

Book Review Editorial Assistant & Social Media Assistant (paid position)

2020–2023

Canadian Journal of Political Science Cambridge University Press.

Community

Director, Vice-Chair

2022–present

Nature’s Calling Environmental Education (Non-profit organization)

Professional Affiliations

Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA)

American Political Science Association (APSA)